From a tender email to a contract project

KAMCO on BPMSquare: the daily flow, the one-time setup, and what to watch for

BPMSquare

THE DAILY FLOW

1 Email arrives
Inbox shows it. **Create from this email → Deal** makes the tender (you choose what an email becomes).

2 Bid decision
Propose bid decision (Go or No-go, with a reason). An approver approves; the tender moves to Estimating.

3 Bill of quantities
Bill of quantities → Upload revised BOQ. Columns are read for you; check, then create the lines. The **Priced** tile shows how many still need a cost.

4 Cost it
Costing → Cost sources: **New RFQ** (pick suppliers, **Send**; replies by email or **Enter reply**) or **New estimate** from a template. A cost can also be typed in a BOQ row: **Cost / unit → Save cost**.

5 Compare and award
Costing → Compare and award. Lowest valid price is marked; awarding another needs a reason. Cost + markup becomes the rate.

6 Submit the bid
Bid tab: read **Before you submit**, choose **Payment terms**, **Submit bid** (saves the next version). **Send by email** logs it under **Sent to client**.

7 Award
Record the outcome **Won → Create contract project**. Contract value and lines come across; **you allocate the budget** (by BOQ line or work package).

8 Run the project
Budget, Buy-out, Client changes, Client billing, Hand over to the ERP live on the project. Client mail lives on the tender: **Interactions**.

SET UP ONCE (SETTINGS)

SETTING	WHAT TO DO
Connectors → Gmail or Mail server	Connect the **tenders mailbox**, then **Test connection**. Gmail needs an **App Password** (Google Account → Security → 2-Step Verification → App passwords); your normal password is refused. A company mailbox uses **Mail server** with its SMTP and IMAP details.
Inbox channels	**New channel** on that mailbox. Fill **Only from these senders** and/or **Subject contains** (for example `tender, RFQ, BOQ`) so only tender mail is copied in. Leave Team empty.
RFQ → Mail channel	Choose **Your own mailbox** to send RFQs from your address and read replies back.
Tenders	Pick the **approvers**. Keep "Allow self-approval" off in daily use.
Email output	**Send to business partners** for real use. "Specified address" redirects every email to one inbox: for testing only.
Contract projects	**Payment terms**: a few templates (name, milestones) you pick on the Bid tab. **Margin floor %**: the margin turns amber under it. Nothing is guessed: a project shows **Not allocated yet** until you allocate a cost.
Estimate templates	Settings → Estimate templates holds the inputs, rates and rules an estimate is worked out from. Add the starters, then **replace their placeholder rates with your own**. Editing a template never re-prices an existing estimate.
Suppliers	Give each supplier an **email address**. A supplier with none cannot be sent an RFQ.
People	Create a login from each employee (**Employees → Create login**). Everyone sets their own password at first sign-in.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Use a dedicated mailbox** (tenders@…), not a personal inbox. A channel reads the whole mailbox; the filter limits what is kept.
- Mail **from the mailbox's own address** is ignored on purpose. Test from a different address.
- The mailbox is read **every 5 minutes**. **Read mail now** on the channel does it at once.
- **An RFQ must be sent** (not Draft) before Compare and award appears on the tender.
- The **BOQ is uploaded again** from the Bill of quantities tab, even if it came as an email attachment.
- The **bid end date** is not read from the email text: set it on the tender.
- Prices older than the validity window (Tenders settings) are flagged **stale**; reprice or ask again.
- Platform emails (invites, approval notices) need the email key on the server: already set for KAMCO.

IF SOMETHING DOES NOT WORK

- **Test connection fails:** read the message. "Application-specific password required" means a Google App Password is needed.
- **Channel shows an error:** open it; the line under Mailbox names the reason.
- **Email not in the Inbox:** check the filter words and sender, then **Read mail now**.